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UAE Presidential Court

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday met Sheikh Jarrah Jaber Al Ahmad Al Sabah, Minister of Foreign Affairs of Kuwait. The meeting addressed developments in the region and their serious implications for regional and international security and stability amid the continued Iranian terrorist attacks targeting the UAE, Kuwait, and other countries in the region, including attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure.

TRUMP CALLS 45-DAY TRUCE PUSH A 'SIGNIFICANT STEP'

Iran rejects offer, seeks 'definitive end' to war

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said yesterday that Washington is reviewing a proposal for a 45-day ceasefire in the Iran war, calling it a "very significant step" — even as Tehran rejected the plan and fighting intensified.

"It's a significant proposal, it's a significant step. It's not good enough, but it's a very significant step," Trump said, adding intermediaries "are negotiating now."

The proposal, backed by mediators including Egypt, Pakistan and Turkey, outlines an immediate ceasefire and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, with a 15- to 20-day window to finalise a broader settlement.

'Islamabad Accord'

The deal — tentatively dubbed the "Islamabad Accord" — envisions a regional framework governing the strait, followed by final in-person talks in Pakistan's capital.

The proposal, backed by mediators including Egypt, Pakistan and Turkey, outlines an immediate ceasefire and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, with a 15- to 20-day window to finalise a broader settlement.

Officials familiar with the discussions said a final agreement could include Iranian commitments not to pursue nuclear weapons in exchange for sanctions relief and the release of frozen assets.

However, Iran has pushed back. State media reported that Tehran had conveyed a 10-point response rejecting a ceasefire and insisting on a "definitive end to the conflict."

"Iran... has rejected a ceasefire and insists on the need for a definitive end to the conflict," IRNA said.

A senior Iranian official also told Reuters that Tehran would not reopen the Strait

of Hormuz as part of a temporary truce — a key sticking point in the proposal.

An Iranian army spokesman signalled no let-up. "We can continue the war as long as the political authorities see fit," Mohammad Akraminia said, adding that "the enemy must definitely regret it."

Rising threats

The diplomatic push comes amid rising threats. Trump warned the United States would strike Iranian power plants and bridges if Tehran does not reopen the strait.

The White House said no decision has been taken. "This is one of many ideas, and the president has not signed off on it. Operation Epic Fury continues," an official said.

Fighting on the ground showed no signs of easing. Iran's Revolutionary Guards said their intelligence chief, Maj Gen Majid Khademi, was killed in US-Israeli strikes.

Regional tensions also remain high. The UAE said its air defences intercepted 12 ballistic missiles, 2 cruise missiles, and 19 drones launched from Iran.

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BRT system, new highway to ease UAE traffic

Dh6 billion Fourth Federal Highway Project to span 68km

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

A high-level UAE committee yesterday reviewed several infrastructure projects, among them plans for a new highway that would connect several emirates and further reduce transit time, as well as a bus corridor system.

Chaired by Suhail Mohamed Al Mazrouei, Minister of Energy and Infrastructure, the

UAE Infrastructure and Housing Council discussed the progress of the Fourth Federal Highway Project, a Dh6 billion undertaking that would span 68 kilometres.

The proposed federal highway will have 10 major interchanges, between six and eight lanes in each direction, as well as four flyovers.

Improving connectivity

Discussions also covered a comprehensive study on developing an integrated mass transit network linking Dubai, Sharjah and Ajman in response to growing daily

commuting demand. The proposed network would include 10 main routes featuring bus rapid transit (BRT) systems and dedicated lanes, with connections to key transport hubs such as metro stations and city centres.

The council also reviewed responses to recent adverse weather conditions and measures taken to ensure traffic continuity and road safety during periods of heavy rain, highlighting the importance of applying lessons learned to strengthen preparedness and future response capabilities.

Nafis programme extended until 2040

UAE rolls out new benefits for Emirati families and private sector workers

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

In implementation of the directives of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court and Chairman of the Board of Directors of the Emirati Talent Competitiveness Council (ETCC), announced the extension of the Nafis programme until 2040.

The announcement reflects the wise leadership's commitment to sustaining Emiratisation programmes, creating an attractive and stable work environment for Emirati citizens, and cementing their role as a key partner in the UAE's comprehensive economic and social development journey.

The ETCC Board of Directors convened yesterday at Qasr Al Watan, where it approved a package of updates to the Nafis programme in alignment with the Year of Family 2026. Central to these updates is the expansion

of the Children's Allowance for Emirati beneficiaries, removing the previous cap on the number of eligible children, in line with the nation's drive to empower the family as the cornerstone of society.

Salary support

The package further introduces a salary support programme for children of Emirati mothers who are themselves employed in the private sector, and a salary support programme for wives of Emirati citizens working in the private sector, reflecting the leadership's commitment to strengthening family stability and enabling all segments of society to play an active role in the labour market.

Sheikh Mansour said: "This extension speaks to the strategic importance of Nafis as a national instrument for advancing Emiratisation, deepening collaboration between the public and private sectors, and providing a dynamic and stable work environment for our citizens. It is grounded in a firm belief that people are the nation's greatest asset, and in our unwavering commitment to developing national talent, fostering a culture of innovation and excellence, and investing in people as a lasting source of strength for the UAE's standing among the world's leading nations."

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